



COOPERATIVE POWER 1. Union Home and Cooperative Minister Amit Shah handing an equity grant to Vijay Sunil Gargote of Silkberry Fed Farmers Producer Company Ltd along with Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis, Deputy CM Eknath Shinde and Agriculture Minister Manikrao Kokate; 2. Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan along with NCCF Chairman Vishal Singh, KRIBHCO Chairman Dr Chandra Pal Singh, NCUI Chairman Dileep Sanghani, NAFED Chairman Jethabhai Ahir inaugurating the event; 3. Audience at the summit

COOPERATION

NMENT REITERATED ITS PLAN TO TAKE COOPERATIVES TO EVERY PANCHAYAT



on June 20. The event was attended by Amit Shah, Union home minister and minister of cooperation; Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Union minister of agriculture and farmers' welfare and minister of rural development; and Devendra Fadnavis, chief minister, Maharashtra, among other dignitaries.

Shah said while the country is known for the cooperation movement, it has an uneven presence. It is strong in western states like Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka and Goa, but has been weakened in the northern and eastern states. The government now plans to ensure that not even a single village panchayat is bereft of a cooperative society.

Chouhan said the government is working to ensure food security and a nutritious diet and soil safety besides increasing agricultural incomes.

Fadnavis pointed out how a sector like cooperatives, which has a rich history, had no separate ministry in the Union government. "Prime Minister Modiji recognised the power of cooperation and created a separate Ministry of Cooperation for the first time in India," he said.

The summit also saw prizes being distributed to winners of various competitions, grants of equity to three Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) supported by NAFED (National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Ltd), and distribution of certificates to five FPOs for launch of NAFED Bazaar franchisees. ■